

ENG519 SHORT HANDOUTS

MIDTERM

Lesson 06 to 10

(ENG519)Curriculum Design

EFFORT BY VUHELPERS24 TEAM

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Lesson-06

SITUATION/ENVIRONMENT ANALYSIS -II

Topic-026: Learner Factors

What factors should curriculum designers consider about learners before starting a project?

Curriculum designers should consider learners' backgrounds, expectations, beliefs, and preferred learning styles.

Why is it important to know about learners' past language learning experiences?

Knowing about past language learning experiences helps in tailoring the curriculum to the learners' needs.

What are some questions to assess learner motivation to learn English?

Questions may include assessing the learners' level of motivation and interest in learning English.

How can cultural factors impact learners' views on language teaching?

Cultural factors can influence learners' expectations and beliefs about language teaching.

What is the significance of understanding whether learners are a homogeneous or heterogeneous group?

Knowing the diversity within the learner group can guide curriculum design and teaching methods.

What types of learning approaches might learners favor?

Learners may prefer teacher-led, student-focused, or small-group work approaches.

Topic-027: Adoption Factors

Why is it important to consider adoption factors when introducing a new curriculum or materials?

Adoption factors help determine the ease or difficulty of implementing a new curriculum or materials.

What are some questions to assess the advantages of a curriculum change?

Questions should explore whether the proposed curriculum change offers more advantages than current practices.

Why is compatibility with existing beliefs and practices crucial?

Compatibility with existing beliefs and practices influences the acceptance of curriculum changes.

What are some considerations regarding the complexity of the innovation?

Assess whether the innovation is easy to understand and implement.

How can clear communication benefit the acceptance of the innovation?

Clear communication helps teachers and institutions understand the features and benefits of the innovation.

Topic-028: Exemplification of Environment Analysis

What constraints were identified in the example of an environment analysis for young Japanese learners?

Constraints included limited class and contact time with English, potential drop in interest, language proficiency variation, and strong identification with Japan.

How do these constraints affect curriculum design for the young Japanese learners?

Constraints lead to recommendations like involving parents, making activities fun, teacher-centered activities, and focusing on meaning in language activities.

Topic-029: Environment Constraints

What wider aspects of the situation should be considered during environment analysis?

Consider institutional or government policies, attitudes towards the target language, and the socio-political context.

What are some wider aspects of the situation that should be considered in environment analysis, apart from the immediate classroom context?

In environment analysis, it's crucial to consider wider aspects of the situation beyond the immediate classroom context. These may include institutional, government, and sociopolitical factors. Some examples of wider aspects to consider are:

Institutional Policies: Some institutions or government policies may mandate the use of the target language in schools. This requirement can significantly influence curriculum design and implementation.

Attitudes Towards the Target Language: In post-colonial societies, there may be negative attitudes toward the target language. These attitudes can impact the reception and success of the curriculum.

Socio-Political Context: The political and national context plays a vital role. For instance, if the target language is recognized as one of a country's official languages, the environment will differ greatly from a situation where the target language provides employment and educational opportunities. These variations in the sociopolitical context have implications for curriculum design.

Topic-030: Understanding the Constraints

Why is it important to understand the nature of constraints like class size?

Understanding constraints like class size helps in designing a curriculum that suits the specific environment.

What does research on teaching large classes provide insights into?

Research on teaching large classes offers insights into group work, class size's effect on learning, and individualization.

Topic-031: Steps in Environment Analysis

What are the steps in environment analysis?

The steps include brainstorming environment factors, choosing the most important ones, gathering relevant information, considering their effects on course design, and repeating the process.

Why is environment analysis crucial in curriculum design?

Environment analysis ensures that the course aligns with local and wider requirements by taking into account important factors like class size, motivation, proficiency, and special purposes.

Lesson-07

NEEDS ANALYSIS -I

Topic-032: Introduction to Needs Analysis

What is the main aim of needs analysis?

The main aim of needs analysis is to critically examine what needs to be learned and what the learners want to learn, ensuring the course contains relevant and useful content.

What are the basic assumptions of curriculum development?

One basic assumption of curriculum development is that it should be based on an analysis of learners' needs.

When did the concept of needs analysis emerge in curriculum development?

Needs analysis as a distinct and necessary phase in planning educational programs emerged in the 1960s as part of the systems approach to curriculum development.

Topic-033: The Purposes of Needs Analysis

What are some purposes of needs analysis in language teaching?

Needs analysis in language teaching may be used to find out what language skills a learner needs for specific roles, assess existing courses, determine who needs training, identify important changes, address gaps in skills, and collect information about learner problems.

Topic-034: What are Needs?

How is the term "needs" defined in the context of needs analysis?

The term "needs" is not straightforward and can refer to wants, desires, demands, expectations, motivations, lacks, constraints, and requirements. Needs often relate to the difference between what learners can do in a language and what they should be able to do.

What influences what is identified as a need?

What is identified as a need depends on judgment and reflects the interests and values of those making the judgment, which can vary among teachers, learners, employers, and other stakeholders.

Topic-035: The Users of Needs Analysis

Who are the end users of a needs analysis in revising a curriculum?

The end users may include curriculum officers, teachers, learners, textbook writers, testing personnel, staff of tertiary institutions, and others depending on the context and purpose of the analysis.

Why is it important to consider the likely audiences in planning a needs analysis?

Considering the likely audiences is crucial to ensure that the information they need is obtained and that the needs analysis has the desired impact.

Topic-036: The Target Population

What is the target population in a needs analysis?

The target population refers to the people about whom information will be collected to meet the needs analysis purposes.

What factors influence the approach to sampling in a needs analysis?

Factors influencing the approach to sampling include the homogeneity of the population, the need to study subgroups within the sample, and the size of the population. Specialized advice may be needed for large target populations.

Lesson-08

Sir Zahid

NEEDS ANALYSIS -II

Topic-037: Administering the Needs Analysis

Who administers the needs analysis?

Needs analysis can be administered by a team of personnel or individual teachers, depending on the situation.

In the context of needs analysis, what considerations are involved in determining who will administer the needs analysis and how the results will be collected and analyzed?

Administering a needs analysis involves various considerations. It encompasses decisions about who will carry out the analysis, how the data will be collected, and the method of analysis. The scope and demands of needs analysis can vary greatly, from surveying an entire school population in a country to studying a small group of learners in a single institution. Depending on the situation, a dedicated team of personnel may be assembled for this purpose, or it may involve a small group of interested teachers. In some language programs, informal needs analysis is an integral part of a teacher's ongoing responsibilities.

Topic-038: Procedures for Conducting Needs Analysis

What sources of information can be used in needs analysis?

Needs analysis can gather information from sources such as student writing samples, test data, teacher reports, expert opinions, interviews, textbooks, surveys, and more.

Topic-039: Task Analysis and Case Studies

What is target situation analysis in needs analysis?

Target situation analysis focuses on the nature and effect of target language communication in specific situations, helping determine the linguistic characteristics needed for language courses.

Topic-040: Designing the Needs Analysis

What are the practical procedures involved in designing a needs analysis?

The procedures include literature survey, survey questionnaires, contacting others who conducted similar surveys, interviews with teachers, selecting participating departments, developing questionnaires, piloting, subject selection, and data collection.

Topic-041: Making Use of the Information Obtained

What are some examples of information obtained in needs analysis?

Information from needs analysis can include situations where English is used, common difficulties encountered, feedback on learner performance, error frequencies, preferences in teaching activities, and more.

Topic-042: Evaluating Needs Analysis

What does reliable needs analysis involve?

Reliable needs analysis involves using standardized tools systematically, such as checklists and standardized analysis procedures.

Why is validity important in needs analysis?

Validity in needs analysis ensures that the gathered information is relevant and important to address the specific needs of learners.

Topic-043: Example in Needs Analysis

What was the purpose of the needs analysis conducted in Auckland University in 1997?

The purpose was to determine whether the current courses met the needs of non-native English-speaking students and improve their language proficiency.

Can you provide an example of a needs analysis conducted at Auckland University in 1997, and what were the key findings and recommendations from this analysis?

In 1997, Auckland University in New Zealand conducted a needs analysis to determine whether their current courses met the needs of non-native English-speaking students (NNES). The university was facing the challenge of enhancing the language proficiency of NNES students as their population continued to grow in the largest university in New Zealand, with roughly 26,000 students. To conduct this needs analysis, the university gathered insights from previous surveys and designed two new questionnaires specifically addressing the issues and problems faced by NNES students. These questionnaires collected demographic information and information about different language skills. The analysis revealed several findings, such as a need to develop reading habits among NNES students and proposed changes in the syllabus. The needs analysis informed the university about the challenges and needs of NNES students, leading to recommendations for improving the courses to better meet their language learning requirements.

Topic-044: Issues in Needs Analysis

What is the risk of neglecting learners' needs in course design?

Neglecting learners' needs in course design can lead to a course that doesn't meet the basic requirements and isn't relevant or satisfying.

Lesson-09

TWENTY PRINCIPLES -I

Topic-045: Introduction to Twenty Principles-I

What is the aim of this lesson TWENTY PRINCIPLES?

The aim of this lesson is to critically analyze how learning can be encouraged with the framework of language curriculum design.

What is the purpose of this lesson TWENTY PRINCIPLES?

The purpose of this lesson is to provide a sensible basis to guide teachers and help them design courses based on certain principles.

How are the principles in this lesson categorized?

The principles are divided into three groups, representing the three major divisions of the central circle in the curriculum design diagram.

Topic-046: Introduction to Twenty Principles-II

What does the first group of principles in this lesson focus on?

The first group of principles deals with content and sequencing.

What is the aim of the principles related to content and sequencing?

The aim of these principles is to ensure that learners gain something useful from the course.

What does the second group of principles in this lesson focus on?

The second group of principles deals with format and presentation.

What is the significance of the third group of principles in this lesson?

The third group of principles deals with monitoring and assessment, and to some degree evaluation.

Topic-047: First Group of Twenty Principles: Content and Sequencing (Principles 1-2)

What is the first principle in the first group of principles?

The first principle is "Frequency."

How does the principle of "Frequency" apply to language courses?

A language course should focus on high-frequency items, which provide the best coverage of language in use.

What is the second principle in the first group of principles?

The second principle is "Strategies and autonomy."

What does the principle of "Strategies and autonomy" aim to do?

It aims to train learners to become effective and independent language learners.

Topic-048: First Group of Twenty Principles: Content and Sequencing (Principles 3-4)

What is the third principle in the first group of principles?

The third principle is "Spaced retrieval."

Why is "Spaced retrieval" important in language learning?

It is important to provide learners with repeated opportunities to focus on items in various contexts, based on research about the effects of repetition on learning.

What is the fourth principle in the first group of principles?

The fourth principle is "Language System."

How does the principle of "Language System" relate to language learning?

It emphasizes that the language focus should be on generalizable features of the language system, enabling learners to make creative use of the language.

Topic-049: First Group of Twenty Principles: Content and Sequencing (Principle - 5-6)

What is the fifth principle in the first group of principles?

The fifth principle is "Keep moving forward."

How does the "Keep moving forward" principle apply to language courses?

It means that the course should progressively cover useful language items, skills, and strategies, with explicit language teaching goals.

What is the sixth principle in the first group of principles?

The sixth principle is "Teach-ability."

Why is "Teach-ability" important in language instruction?

It emphasizes that teaching language items should consider the most favorable sequencing of these items and the readiness of learners to learn them.

Topic-050: First Group of Twenty Principles: Content and Sequencing (Principle 7-8)

What is the seventh principle in the first group of principles?

The seventh principle is "Learning Burden."

What does "Learning Burden" focus on?

It emphasizes helping learners make the most effective use of their previous knowledge.

What is the eighth principle in the first group of principles?

The eighth principle is "Interference."

How does the "Interference" principle relate to language course design?

It suggests that items in a language course should be sequenced to avoid interference effects and enhance learning by grouping related items effectively.

Lesson-10

TWENTY PRINCIPLES -II

Topic-051: Second Group of Twenty Principles (Principle 1-2)

Principle 1: Motivation

What does Principle 1 (Motivation) emphasize?

It emphasizes the importance of learners' attitude toward language learning and the role of motivation in learning.

What is intrinsic motivation?

Intrinsic motivation is motivation that comes from within the learner, driven by personal interest and satisfaction.

How can teachers encourage intrinsic motivation in learners?

By making the subject matter relevant and interesting, giving learners control over their learning, setting achievable goals, and showing them their progress.

Principle 2: Four Strands

What does Principle 2 (Four Strands) recommend regarding a language course?

It recommends balancing the four strands of meaning-focused input, language-focused learning, meaning-focused output, and fluency activities in a course.

How should the time allocation be for these four strands?

On average, equal time should be given to each of these four strands in the learner's language experience.

What does it mean for time allocation in class and outside of class?

Time in class and outside class can be considered if the learner gains appropriate language activity fitting into these strands.

Topic-052: Second Group of Twenty Principles (Principle 3)

Principle 3: Comprehensible input

What is Principle 3 (Comprehensible input) about?

It emphasizes the need for substantial quantities of interesting and comprehensible receptive activities in listening and reading.

What experiment illustrates the impact of this principle?

The Elley and Mangubhai experiment, where self-directed reading of interesting children's books significantly improved English proficiency.

What conditions are necessary for this approach to work?

Learners need access to large quantities of interesting reading or listening material at a suitable level, and such material should be monitored but not followed by numerous exercises.

Topic-053: Second Group of Twenty Principles (Principle 4)

Principle 4: Fluency

What does Principle 4 (Fluency) focus on in a language course?

It emphasizes the importance of providing activities to increase the fluency with which learners can use the language they already know.

What is the difference between fluency and accuracy?

Fluency focuses on the speed and ease of using known language, while accuracy emphasizes correctness in language use.

What activity is described as promoting fluency?

Activities where learners speak for several minutes without interruption, such as speaking in pairs and changing partners.

Topic-054: Second Group of Twenty Principles (Principle 5-6)

Principle 5: Output

What is the main point of Principle 5 (Output)?

Learners should be encouraged to produce language through speaking and writing in various discourse types.

Why is output important for language learning?

It requires learners to use their language knowledge actively, make decisions about language use, and develop productive skills.

What balance in language production is recommended in a course?

About 25% of the total learning time should be spent on activities involving language production.

Principle 6: Deliberate Learning

What is the focus of Principle 6 (Deliberate Learning)?

It emphasizes language-focused learning in areas like the sound system, vocabulary, grammar, and discourse to support language learning.

What are some examples of language-focused learning activities?

Dictation, repetition drills, memorizing dialogues, analyzing cohesive devices, learning vocabulary, and more.

How should language-focused learning be seen in relation to meaning-focused activities?

It should be seen as a support for meaning-focused activities rather than a substitute for them.

Topic-055: Second Group of Twenty Principles (Principle 7-8)

Principle 7: Time on Task

What does Principle 7 (Time on Task) highlight?

It emphasizes that learners should spend as much time as possible using and focusing on the second language for effective learning.

What is the relationship between time spent on language learning and learning outcomes?

The more time learners spend on language learning, the more they learn.

Principle 8: Depth of Processing

What is the central idea of Principle 8 (Depth of Processing)?

Learners should process language items deeply and thoughtfully for effective learning.

What does the "levels of processing" hypothesis propose?

It suggests that the quality of mental activity at the moment of learning is the most crucial factor for effective learning.

How can teachers apply this principle in their teaching?

By engaging learners in activities that encourage thoughtful and meaningful processing of language.

Topic-056: Second Group of Twenty Principles (Principle 9-10)

Principle 9: Integrative Motivation

What is the focus of Principle 9 (Integrative Motivation)?

It highlights the importance of presenting the course in a way that fosters positive attitudes toward the language, its users, and the learning process.

What are affective factors in language learning?

Affective factors include motivation, language anxiety, opinions about native speakers, and attitudes toward the teacher.

Principle 10: Learning Style

What does Principle 10 (Learning Style) address?

It suggests that learners should have the opportunity to work with the learning material in ways that suit their individual learning styles.

How can a language course accommodate different learning styles?

By providing choices and flexibility in various aspects of learning, such as group size, pace, medium, mental process, and more.

What is the goal of considering individual learning styles in a course?

It aims to make learning more effective by allowing learners to use their preferred learning style and also encouraging them to explore other learning approaches.

Topic-057: Third Group of Twenty Principles (Principle 1-2)

Principle 1: Ongoing Needs and Environment Analysis

What does Principle 1 (Ongoing Needs and Environment Analysis) emphasize in curriculum design?

It stresses that material selection, grading, presentation, and assessment should consider learners' needs, teaching conditions, and available resources.

Why is environment analysis important in course planning?

It ensures that the course aligns with the specific context and conditions in which it will be delivered.

Principle 2: Feedback

What does Principle 2 (Feedback) refer to?

It suggests that learners should receive helpful feedback to improve the quality of their language use.

How is feedback defined in communication theory?

It is the information provided to the sender, receiver, or observer of a message about various aspects of the communication process.

Why is feedback important in language learning?

It helps learners correct errors, refine language use, and enhance their overall language skills.

Topic-058: Using the List of Principles

How can the list of principles be used in language teaching?

It can guide course and lesson design, evaluate existing courses, inform teachers about developments in the field, and help with reflective practice and professional development.

What are some applications of the list of principles?

Course design, course evaluation, teacher development, and as a reference point in teacher training programs.

How can the principles be used to reflect on teaching practices?

They can help teachers consider if their techniques, activities, and methods align with the principles, and whether they are promoting effective learning.

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